## CONCLUSION

This chapter has shown how gender roles, and the insecurities that emanate from them, provide community-wide support and labour for the conflict in Kachin State. The insecurity that women experience during and after conflict is co-constitutive of gender-based inequalities rooted in economic and political systems of power. These, ironically, propel women to support political violence in ways that ensure their inclusion preserves rather than upsets the very gendered insecurities they set out to challenge.

Using a feminist political economy approach has helped to highlight the crucial role the household plays in providing labour and support for the conflict. As this chapter has argued, gendered norms position women as the primary caretakers of near and extended families. This means women often lack the time and income to participate in public decision-making processes, and are relegated to lower-level support roles in the army. Exclusion from participation in political decision-making processes impacts women's ability to have voice and leaves little room for redress. This systematic marginalization and devaluation of their rights as equal citizens increases their insecurity. The insecurity women face is then directly related to their gendered status, and exacerbated by their ethnic and religious minority identity. Importantly, it is precisely their gender-specific experiences of physical and material insecurity, including poverty, rape, and discrimination, which provides the context for women's support of and participation in political violence.

Mainstream research and policy interventions on the conflict in Kachin State tend to treat the state or military actors as both the objects and subjects of security and, as such, fail to take into consideration people's gendered experiences of insecurity. By failing to consider this dimension, they fail to address how insecurity and marginalization, and by association, conflict, might be prevented in the long term. In focusing on the themes of insecurity and violence as expressed by Kachin women involved in military organizations, this chapter has offered a new perspective, encouraging scholars and researchers of Myanmar to think more broadly about insecurity in relation to gender, political representation, and socio-economic status and rights in Kachin State. By exploring the ways Kachin women have developed strategies to combat insecurity, this chapter has shown how women from marginalized communities are stakeholders in both conflict and peace building, and must be recognized as such.